

CDD:

Game Title: 鬼の田 (Oni no Ta) ["The Demon's Field"]

Genre: Cozy Simulator / Narrative Adventure

Platform: PC/Console

Target Audience: Ages 16-25, players interested in cozy farming simulators with narrative depth and moral choice systems

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1. High Concept Overview

"Oni no Ta" is a 2D top-down narrative farming simulator set in rural Heian-era Japan. The game blends cozy agricultural mechanics with a divine power-management system, offering players a morally driven branching experience. The game explores the theme of power vs restraint, using farming as both a mechanic and metaphor. The project targets the growing indie market of players who enjoy low-combat, emotionally driven simulation games with narrative consequence systems. Unlike traditional simulators, "Oni no Ta" introduces a destabilizing "Divine Energy" mechanic that punishes overuse of power and transforms gameplay depending on player behavior. A bored war deity descends into a rural farming village and attempts to learn rice cultivation. Whether he learns restraint, or destroys the village, depends entirely on the player.

The game combines:

- Cozy simulation
- Narrative RPG elements
- Optional timed action sequence (alternate ending)

2. Game pillars/Design goals

- Power vs Restraint as a core mechanic
- Cozy farming grounded in historical Heian-era practices
- Narrative-driven character relationships
- Consequences instead of traditional failure states
- Emotional contrast between peaceful simulation and destructive choices

3. Target Audience

- Players who enjoy simulators
- Narrative-driven indie game fans
- Players interested in morally driven branching paths
- Ages 16-25 (has themes of power, responsibility, identity)
- Players who prefer not to think too much while playing a game

4. Genre + Platform

Genre: Cozy Simulator/Narrative Adventure

Platforms: PC/Console

Session Length: 1-2 hours per story cycle

5. Core gameplay loop

- Explore village hub
- Interact with villagers and daughter (Jojo)
- Participate in rice farming tasks
- Manage 'Divine Energy' and 'Boredom Meter'
- Choose restraint or indulgence in power
- World reacts to player behavior
- Unlock peaceful or destructive endings

6. Mechanics overview

- Divine Energy System
 1. Dorisu possesses overwhelming power. If overused, crops mutate, soil darkens, and curses form.
- Boredom Meter
 1. Repeating simple farming tasks raises boredom. When full:
 - Divine energy leaks
 - Crops mutate
 - Villagers react with fear
 - Rampage Mode becomes available

- Farming Mechanics
 1. Tile-based rice planting
 2. Irrigation control
 3. Seasonal crop cycles
 4. Tool usage and stamina balancing
- Relationship System
 1. NPC reactions change based on:
 2. How restrained Dorisu is
 3. How he treats villagers
 4. His daughter's influence
- Rampage Mode (Ending 2)
 1. 60-second timed destruction sequence
 2. Onmyōji and shrine exorcists attempt to seal him
 3. Visual and audio shift to horror tone
 4. Two possible destructive outcomes: sealed or victorious

7. Theme, Settings + Aesthetics

- Setting: Rural farming village outside Heian-Kyo during the Heian period.
- Perspective:
 1. Top-down 2D sprite-based design inspired by classic Pokémon titles.
- Color Palette:
 1. Soft rice greens, warm browns, muted water tones.
- Seasonal Changes:
 1. Spring seedlings
 2. Summer lush growth
 3. Autumn harvest
 4. Winter frost
- Rampage Mode shifts palette to:
 1. Desaturated tones
 2. Red overlays
 3. Darkened skies
- Peaceful Mode:
 1. Shamisen and flute background music
 2. Flowing water
 3. Insects and temple bells
- Rampage Mode:
 1. Heavy percussion
 2. Reduced ambience
 3. Distant chanting
 4. Whispers and screams

8. Progression + Replayability

The game consists of multiple narrative outcomes

- Peaceful farming ending
- Sealed deity ending
- Dominant dark god ending
- Different village states based on restraint

Replayability comes from moral choice and behavioral management from the player's side.

9. Emotional/Player exp goals

- Reflection on power and restraint
- Calm satisfaction through labor
- Tension when boredom rises
- Emotional contrast between nurture and destruction
- Players should feel:
 1. Powerful but conflicted
 2. Responsible for consequences
 3. Attached to character dynamics

10. Competitive Analysis

Unlike traditional farming simulators, this game integrates a Divine Power mechanic that destabilizes gameplay if misused. Unlike pure action games, destruction is optional and narratively driven. The contrast between cozy simulation and timed destruction creates a unique emotional duality.

11. Scope + Feasibility

Estimated Development Time: 6-8 months

Estimated Team Size: 5-7 developers

- Required Roles:
 1. 1 Game Designer
 2. 1 Narrative Designer
 3. 2 Pixel Artists (characters + environments)
 4. 1 Programmer (mechanics + systems)
 5. 1 Sound Designer / Composer
 6. 1 QA Tester

Asset scope is controlled through:

- 2D sprite-based art
- Limited map regions
- Reusable tile systems

Overall Complexity: Medium

Feasible for indie or student-level production.

12. Future expansion

- Additional crop systems
- Expanded Onmyōji factions
- Alternate regional villages
- Expanded divine backstory
- Co-op farming mode